



BARD ON THE BEACH - BURRARD CIVIC MARINA

Temporary Storage Facility Lease of Space

Park Board Committee Meeting
Monday, March 30, 2026



PURPOSE/OBJECTIVES

- Present new opportunity involving the lease of space at Burrard Civic Marina land storage lot for use as a temporary storage facility
- Review the needs and benefits of this initiative
- Seek the Board's approval to pursue the opportunity for a period of ten (10) years



BACKGROUND | Bard on the Beach

- Established in 1990, BOTB is Western Canada's largest not-for-profit Shakespeare Festival
- Presented in Vanier Park annually
- Offers Shakespeare plays, related dramas, and special events from June to September
- BOTB educational division offers year-round program opportunities



BACKGROUND | Bard on the Beach

- Several challenges have emerged over the Festival's 35+ year history; created both financial and operational pressures
- BOTB and Park Board staff have worked collaboratively to explore solutions for these challenges
- Pilot program successfully approved by Board in 2024
- Second opportunity now identified with potential meaningful benefits



PROPOSAL

- BOTB is seeking to lease approximately 20,000 square feet at Burrard Marina to create a temporary storage facility (Quonset tent structure)
- Requested space is located in marina land storage lot; staff determined space can be made available without significant impacts to marina operations
- 10-year term required to offset/recover investment



WHY IS THIS NEEDED?

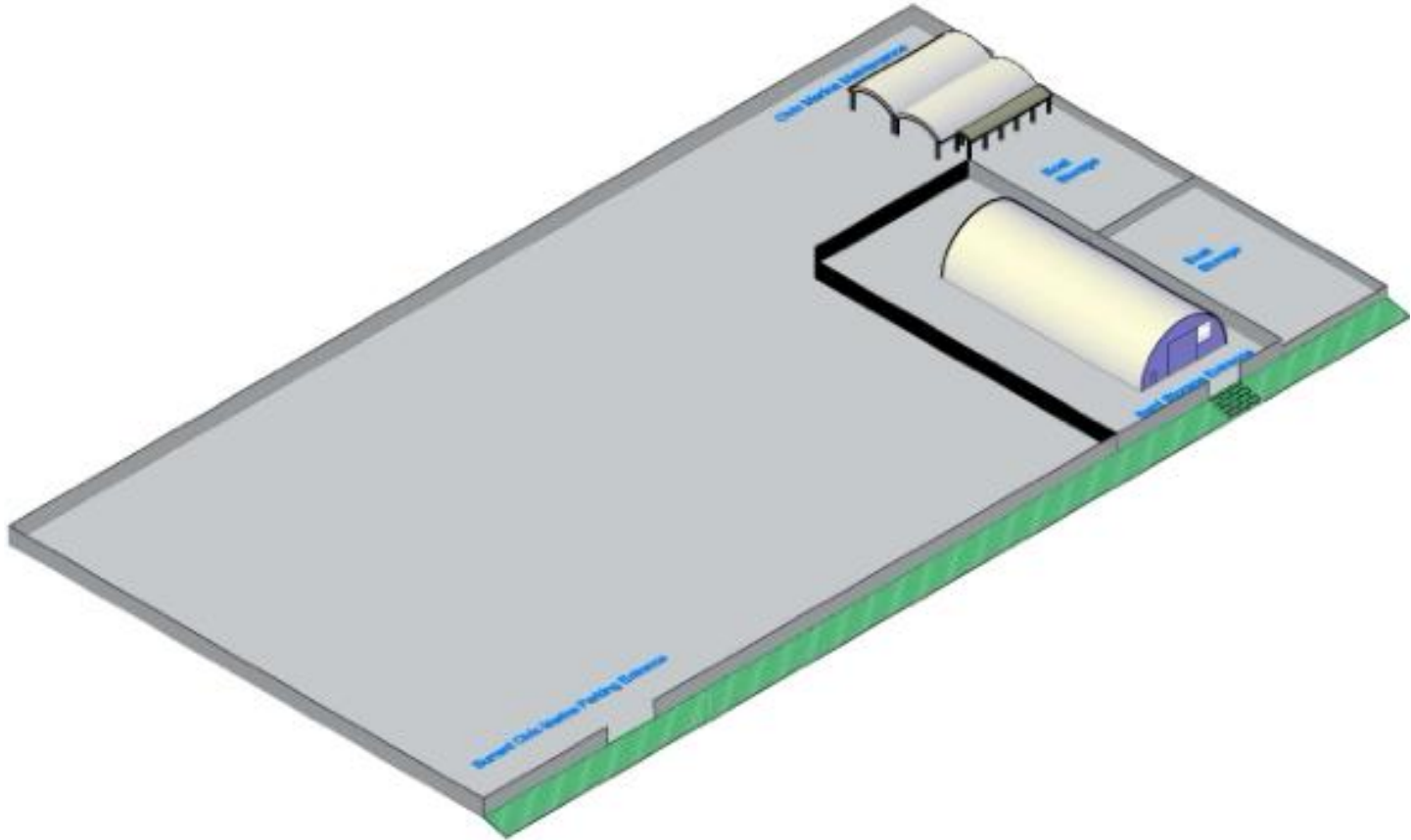
- Post-pandemic cost increases are having major impact on financial viability of arts/culture events
- Forced BOTB to review every aspect of their operations
- Current warehouse lease ends in December 2026; market rates for traditional warehouse space are unviable
- Innovative solution needed; meant creating their own storage facility



datenight

**The Celebration of Light
is officially cancelled for
2026 in Vancouver**

HOW WOULD THIS BE EXECUTED?



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BENEFITS

- Supports a more efficient medium-term storage approach
- Enables important cost reduction opportunities for BOTB
- Delivers environmental and neighbourhood impacts
- Protects Park Board revenue streams; annual inflation escalator
- Provides potential administrative efficiencies



KEY CONSIDERATIONS

■ Financial

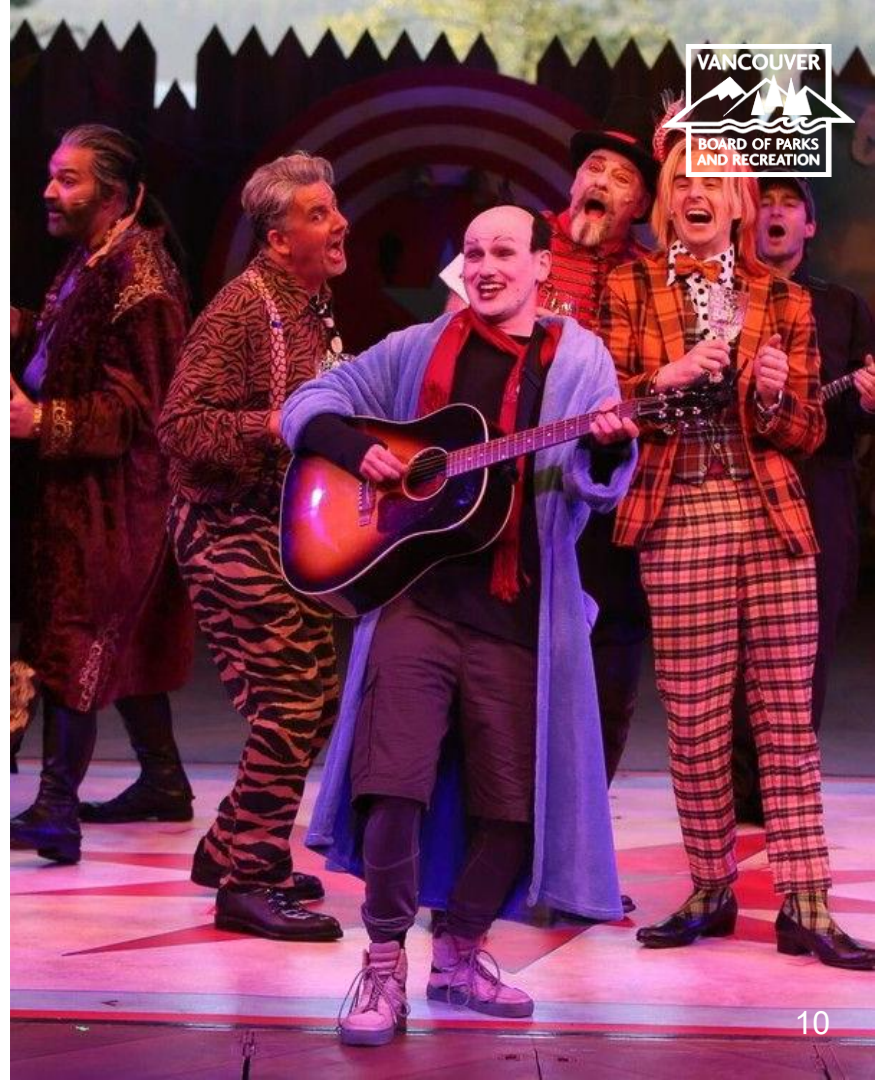
- All expenses to be born by BOTB; no costs to Park Board
- Park Board revenues fully maintained and protected
- Revenues will flow to marina operations

■ Risks

- Initiative considered low risk; minimal impact on marina operations
- Anticipate mitigations for any potential issues

■ Other

- Opportunity is independent and not linked to other initiatives



SUMMARY

- BOTB is longstanding cultural partner
- Facing significant financial and operational pressures
- Staff have worked collaboratively to explore solutions
 - Pilot program approved by Board in 2024 and successfully implemented
 - Second opportunity identified with potential meaningful benefits
- Staff have considered the many aspects of this proposal; confident it can be implemented successfully



RECOMMENDATIONS



- A. THAT the Vancouver Park Board approve a request by Bard on the Beach Shakespeare Festival for the lease of space at Burrard Civic Marina land storage lot for use as a temporary storage facility, including the installation of a Quonset tent structure, as outlined in this report;
- B. THAT the Vancouver Park Board authorize staff to negotiate, to the satisfaction of the Park Board's General Manager and the City's Director of Legal Services, and enter into an agreement with Bard on the Beach Shakespeare Festival for the abovementioned initiative for a term of ten (10) years; and
- C. THAT no legal rights or obligations shall arise, and no consents, permissions, or licenses are granted hereby, and none shall arise or be granted hereafter unless and until all contemplated legal documentation has been executed and delivered by all parties.

